

# Emma Nelson

Halifax, NS

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emmastfrancis.github.io

## EDUCATION

### PhD, Sociology (*in progress*)

Dalhousie University

2025 – present

### Master, Environmental Studies

*Diploma, Community Planning*

*Diploma, Environmental*

*Education*

York University

2018–2020

### Master, English

York University

2017–2018

### Bachelor, English Literature

*Minor, Gender Studies*

Montana State University

2013–2017

## AWARDS

### SSHRC CGS Doctoral

2025 – 2028

### Dalhousie President's Award

2025 – 2027

### MES thesis nominated for

### Outstanding Paper Series

Feb 2020

### SSHRC Partnership Engage

Feb 2020

### SSHRC CGS Master's

2019 – 2020

### York Graduate Fellowship

2017 – 2019

### York Graduate Scholarship

2017 – 2019

### Inkling Award

## EXPERIENCE

### Research assistant — Dalhousie University and InclusionNS

*July 2026 – ongoing*

- Supported by MITACS Accelerate
- Scoping review of deinstitutionalization of community living facilities for people with mental disabilities across Canada
- Second phase planned for 2027: interviewing community members and providers, data analysis, presentation and publication of results

### Teaching assistant — Dalhousie University

*September 2025 – ongoing*

- Grading and advising for 2000 and 3000-level courses

### Writing tutor — Dalhousie University Writing Centre

*September 2025 – ongoing*

- Drafting, grammar, clarity, and copyediting assistance

### Owner-operator — Cardamom Pod Cafe

*January 2023 – August 2025*

- Small cafe located in Pugwash, NS
- Baker, barista, and social media manager

### Research assistant — York University

*July – Dec 2020*

- Created database of land transfers between Indigenous nations and the Crown between 1790–mid 1900s
- Mapped findings using GIS to show the development of Canada as dependent on the degradation of Indigenous land holdings

### Research assistant — York University

*Feb – Oct 2020*

- Supported by SSHRC Partnership Engage
- Joint project with City of Toronto's Shelter, Support, and Housing Administration
- Interviewed international experts and service providers on difficulties with public engagement when introducing new shelters

May 2016

**Montana State University  
President's Scholarship**  
Sept 2013

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SKILLS

- Qualitative methods
- Multiple regression analysis
- Designing visuals  
(interactive, graphic design,  
textile art)
- Digital mapping
- Grant writing

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SOFTWARE FAMILIARITY

- Linux
- QGIS
- Stata 18
- NVivo / hand coding
- Excel (intermediate)
- InDesign
- LaTeX, VS Code
- Microsoft & Google suites
- Canva
- Social media management  
(major platforms)

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INTERESTS

- Midwifery / birth care
- Death care / death cultures
- Rites of passage
- Ritual
- Professionalization
- Medicalization
- Nursing history
- Policy development
- Material cultures
- Participant-driven research
- Alternative / visual methods

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PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

**Presenter** CSA, "'Return of the 'Radical': How the history of  
Nova Scotian midwifery can inform feminist organizing"  
*June 2026*

**Presenter** CSA, "Mapping Memories: An interactive method to  
recover, visualize, and celebrate midwifery's history in Nova  
Scotia"  
*June 2026*

**Presenter** CASCA, "Is there a place for contemplative practice  
in anthropology? On silence, listening, and hearing in the  
field"  
*June 2026*

**Co-author** "Reconciling Relationships with the Land Through  
Land Acknowledgments" with Dr. Deborah McGregor in  
*Sacred Civics*  
*May 2022*

**Author** *Container gardening: A how-to* (self-published)  
*Jul 2021*

**Producer** *Planning through land acknowledgments* (podcast)  
*Aug 2020*

**Guest lecturer** Several conferences and university courses,  
"Understanding land acknowledgments"  
*Aug 2020–May 2024*

**Co-author** York University, "Understanding Cummer Lodge as  
a place of employment"  
*Apr 2020*

**Co-author** York University, "NYC and Toronto: From mega-  
projects to activism and resistance"  
*Oct 2019*

**Presenter** Law Union of Ontario Conference, "Legal observing  
and activism"  
*Oct 2019*

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EXTRACURRICULAR

**OpenThinker** — OpenThink 2026 cohort, Dalhousie University  
*2026 – 2027*

- Competitively selected, stipended programme designed to  
help early-career scholars develop a public following for  
their research
- Received media training

**Student Concerns Subcommittee, Eastern Rep** — Canadian  
Sociological Association

*2026 – 2029*

- Elected for 3-year term

**Trained birth doula** — Sista Midwife Productions

*2020 – current*

